

Threat-Actor Intelligence Report: “Handala”

A concise, original, multi-source intelligence report demonstrating attribution reasoning and structured-analytic-technique fluency.

ASSESSMENT 3 of 4

SUBMIT AS PDF report + ATT&CK table + Diamond Model + IOC table

CONFIDENTIAL — for the named candidate and hiring panel only. Do not distribute outside the recruitment process.

Objective

Produce an independent intelligence report on the threat actor **Handala**. We want demonstrated analysis — not a summary of one article. **Quality of analysis matters far more than length.**

Background (brief)

Handala is a pro-Palestinian threat actor that surfaced publicly in late 2023, associated with data theft, hack-and-leak operations, destructive/wiper activity, and information operations via social media and Telegram, claiming attacks against Israeli government entities, critical-infrastructure organisations, and private-sector companies.

Required research areas

1. **Attribution assessment.** Document Handala’s aliases and the attribution chain linking it to other clusters or hacktivist personas. Use **Analysis of Competing Hypotheses**: lay out the leading attribution hypotheses (e.g. independent hacktivist crew vs. state-nexus / false-flag), the evidence for and against each, and your confidence. **Explicitly flag where public reporting disagrees or is unsupported** — do not simply restate consensus.
2. **Operation workflow.** Describe the observed attack lifecycle: initial access → escalation / lateral movement → collection / exfiltration → impact (leak / wiper) → amplification via Telegram and social media.
3. **MITRE ATT&CK mapping.** Map observed TTPs to ATT&CK techniques **with technique IDs**, and tie each one to a specific reported behaviour or piece of evidence — not a generic guess.
4. **Diamond Model.** Populate Adversary / Capability / Infrastructure / Victim, plus any meta-features you can support from evidence.
5. **Incident analysis.** Select 1–2 claimed incidents and analyse: target, impact, **validation** of the claim (did the victim or an independent source corroborate it?), and IOCs in a table.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLES

- A 3–6 page report with a **TLP marking** on every page.
- An ATT&CK mapping table; a Diamond Model (table or labelled diagram); an IOC table.
- A short “**Confidence & gaps**” section stating, per major claim, whether it is corroborated / single-source / actor-claim-only, and your confidence.

RULES OF ENGAGEMENT — SAFETY & LEGAL (READ FIRST)

This is an **OSINT exercise** — **observe and analyse publicly available information only**. Do not access, download, or redistribute any leaked/stolen dataset the actor has published; analyse the *claims and metadata*, not the victim data itself. Passive viewing of the actor's public channels only.

- **Passive collection only.** Do not register on, transact with, solicit, message, or otherwise interact with any actor, channel, or marketplace. A screenshot of a public listing or post is sufficient — never acquire the goods.
- **Do not download, run, or store** malware, exploit/PoC code, stolen data, credential dumps, or any illicit material. Recording a hash, filename, or handle from an advertisement is fine; obtaining the artefact is not.
- **Use an approved, isolated environment only:** a dedicated VM with host/guest network separation, a VPN, Tor where appropriate, and a clean non-attributable research persona — never personal names, emails, accounts, or devices. **Confirm your setup with the hiring manager before you begin.**
- **Stop-and-report rule.** If you encounter child sexual abuse material, credible threats to life, or graphic violent content: stop immediately, do not screenshot or download, and report to the hiring manager. This is out of scope and may carry legal obligations.
- **Stay within the law of your jurisdiction.** If anything feels legally ambiguous, stop and ask. We are assessing judgment and tradecraft — not willingness to take risks. "I stopped and escalated" is a *passing* answer.

How your submission will be evaluated

Criterion	Weight
Attribution reasoning, ACH & confidence calibration	25
Source diversity & use of primary sources	20
ATT&CK & Diamond Model accuracy (evidence-tied)	20
Incident validation & independent thinking	20
Clarity & structure	15
Total	100

INTEGRITY & HOW WE DETECT GENERATED WORK

This assessment exists specifically to test *independent* analysis. A report that summarises a single source, or reads as generic model output, will not pass — we will ask you to defend your attribution call and walk through every source. As the brief states: we value the quality of your reasoning, not the page count.